



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	Control of Substances Hazardous to Health Regulations 2002 (COSHH)				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

The basic principle of these regulations is to safeguard the health of all of us who have to work with substances that can be hazardous to health. A substance can be a liquid, solid or gas and include micro-organisms and dust. These regulations apply to all places of work.

The main requirements of the regulations are for your employer to:-

- Assess the risk to health arising from the work and what precautions are needed.
- Introduce appropriate measures to prevent or control the risk - use alternative safer substances if possible.
- Ensure by good supervision that control measures are used and that equipment is properly maintained and procedures observed.
- Where necessary, monitor the exposure of the workers and carry out an appropriate form of surveillance of their health.
- Inform, instruct and train employees about the risks and the precautions to be taken. Make sure you are given a COSHH risk assessment for your work activities.

You must co-operate with your employer and wear protective equipment when instructed to do so.

The equipment you are given must be in good condition and your employer cannot charge you for the cost of personal protective equipment provided to comply with the requirements of any Risk Assessment.

COSHH risk assessments are produced from the manufacturer datasheet and should relate specifically to the work activity you will be carrying out.

COSHH risk assessments must be reviewed on a regular basis to ensure their relevance to your working environment and processes.

Discussion Points

List the three ways a substance can enter your body?

What should you do with substances at the end of the day?

Where can you get information about the hazardous substance you are using?

What can you wear to protect yourself against substances?